Interview Notes: CM-6, Configuration Settings

Practice exercise. Harbor Point Medical Group (HPMG) and all people named are fictional. The assessor also played the interviewee.

Date of interview: 2026-11-06 **Assessor:** Musah Issah **Interviewee:** Information Security Officer (ISO), HPMG (fictional) **System:** DC01, domain controller (ad.northstar.test) **Control:** CM-6, Configuration Settings **Method:** Interview, with examination of EV-0054 and EV-0055

Questions and answers

1. **Does HPMG have a documented configuration baseline or standard for DC01, with approved settings? If so, what is it called and who approved it?** No.
2. **If settings differ from it, is there a process to approve and record the deviation?** N/A.
3. **Who approves changes to the DC01 settings, and how is it recorded?** The change control board, through tickets.

Assessor observations

- No configuration baseline exists, so there is no approved set of settings to compare DC01 against, and no deviations can be identified or approved. The answer "N/A" to question 2 follows from question 1.
- Settings are applied through Group Policy: account policy, the logon banner, the inactivity limit, update settings and user rights are in GPOs (EV-0054).
- The audit settings, Security log size and archive setting are not in any GPO examined. They were applied locally on DC01 (EV-0054, EV-0055). The approved audit policy, section 7.1, says to apply them in a GPO.
- A change control board approving changes through tickets is described. No ticket or board record was provided, so this cannot be corroborated.

Preliminary results

- Settings established and documented as a baseline: **Not Met**.

- Settings implemented: **Partly met**. Group Policy covers most settings, but audit and log settings are local only.
- Deviations identified, documented and approved: **Not Met**. No baseline and no process.
- Changes to settings monitored and controlled: **Not Assessed**. A change process is described, but no ticket records were examined.

Control rating: **Other Than Satisfied**.

Recommended fixes

1. Write and approve a configuration baseline for DC01, based on a published secure configuration, and a deviation register.
2. Move the audit and log settings into a Group Policy Object so the system matches the audit policy.
3. Provide change ticket records for recent changes to DC01 settings, so that change control can be assessed.